

NORTHBRIDGE INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

Office of Academic Affairs

COURSE PREREQUISITE RULES 2026

Document code: NIT/AA/PRQ/2026

Version: Version 1.0

Effective from: 1 August 2026

Classification: Academic policy - approved for student reference

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 These rules govern prerequisite and corequisite checks for undergraduate course registration at Northbridge Institute of Technology. They apply together with the approved curriculum and the undergraduate academic regulations.

1.2 The rules are intended to ensure that students possess the knowledge required for a course while providing a clear process for equivalence decisions, curriculum transitions and registration corrections.

2. Definitions

2.1 A prerequisite is a course or requirement that must be completed before registration in a dependent course.

2.2 A corequisite is a course that must have been completed earlier or must be registered in the same semester as the related course.

2.3 Completion means earning a passing grade of P or higher. Attendance, audit status, an incomplete grade or prior registration without a passing grade does not satisfy a prerequisite.

2.4 An equivalent course is a formally approved substitute that carries the same prerequisite effect as the course it replaces.

3. General Registration Rules

3.1 The registration system checks prerequisites against the student's final academic record. A result awaiting publication is not treated as a pass unless the Office of Examinations has issued an official provisional result.

3.2 A student may not remain registered in a dependent course after dropping its corequisite. The dependent course must also be dropped unless the corequisite was completed in an earlier semester.

3.3 Meeting a prerequisite does not guarantee a seat. Registration remains subject to programme restrictions, timetable compatibility, credit limits and course capacity.

3.4 The normal semester load is 18 to 24 credits. Approval is required above 24 credits, with an absolute limit of 27 credits. A student with a CGPA below 5.00 is ordinarily limited to 20 credits.

4. Computer Science Prerequisite Map

CS201 Data Structures - Prerequisite: CS101 Introduction to Programming.

CS202 Object-Oriented Programming - Prerequisite: CS101 Introduction to Programming.

CS205 Web Technologies - Prerequisite: CS101 Introduction to Programming.

CS206 Data Structures Laboratory - Corequisite: CS201 Data Structures.

MA201 Linear Algebra and Probability - Prerequisite: MA101 Engineering Mathematics I.

CS301 Database Management Systems - Prerequisites: CS201 Data Structures and CS204 Database Foundations.

CS302 Operating Systems - Prerequisites: CS201 Data Structures and CS203 Computer Organization.

CS303 Computer Networks - Prerequisite: CS203 Computer Organization.

CS304 Design and Analysis of Algorithms - Prerequisites: CS201 Data Structures and MA102 Engineering Mathematics II.

CS307 Systems Laboratory - Corequisites: CS302 Operating Systems and CS303 Computer Networks.

5. Advanced Course Prerequisites

CS305 Software Engineering - Prerequisite: CS202 Object-Oriented Programming.

CS306 Software Engineering Laboratory - Corequisite: CS305 Software Engineering.

CS401 Artificial Intelligence - Prerequisites: CS201 Data Structures and MA201 Linear Algebra and Probability.

CS402 Information Security - Prerequisites: CS302 Operating Systems and CS303 Computer Networks.

CS403 Cloud Computing - Prerequisites: CS302 Operating Systems and CS303 Computer Networks.

CS404 Natural Language Processing - Prerequisites: CS201 Data Structures and MA201 Linear Algebra and Probability.

CS405 Machine Learning - Prerequisites: CS301 Database Management Systems and MA201 Linear Algebra and Probability.

CS406 Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning Laboratory - Corequisites: CS401 Artificial Intelligence and CS405 Machine Learning.

CS493 Project Phase II - Prerequisite: CS492 Project Phase I.

6. Internship and Project Registration

6.1 CS491 Industry Internship requires prior departmental approval of the host organisation and proposed work. The internship must have an approved duration of at least six weeks.

6.2 Registration for final-year project work normally requires at least 108 earned credits and no more than four active backlogs. A department may also require specific supporting courses for the approved topic.

6.3 Project Phase II may not be registered until Project Phase I has been passed. A deferred or incomplete Phase I result does not satisfy this requirement.

7. Failed, Repeated and Supplementary Courses

7.1 A failed prerequisite continues to block every dependent course until a passing result is recorded. Registration for a supplementary examination does not by itself satisfy the prerequisite.

7.2 When a student repeats and passes a course, the updated result may be used for prerequisite checking from the next registration correction window or from an earlier date announced by Academic Affairs.

7.3 If a prerequisite result changes after re-evaluation, the department shall review affected registrations. A student remains responsible for reporting the changed result during the applicable correction period.

8. Transfer Credit and Equivalence

8.1 Transfer credit satisfies a prerequisite only when the Institute has approved an explicit course equivalence. Similar course titles or equal credit values are not sufficient evidence.

8.2 The department evaluates the syllabus, learning outcomes, assessment level and contact hours before recommending equivalence. The final decision is recorded by the Office of Academic Affairs.

8.3 An approved equivalence must identify the source course, the Northbridge course, the cohort to which it applies and the date of approval.

9. Curriculum Transition

9.1 Students normally follow the curriculum assigned at admission. When a course is discontinued, the department must publish a transition mapping before the relevant registration period.

9.2 A replacement course carries prerequisite effect only to the extent stated in the approved mapping. Credits may not be counted twice when an earlier and replacement course cover the same requirement.

9.3 Students transferred to the 2026 curriculum must satisfy its prerequisite sequence unless the transition order records an approved exception or equivalent course.

10. Exceptional Review

10.1 Prerequisites are not ordinarily waived. A student may request review only where an approved equivalence, delayed official result, curriculum transition or administrative record error may not have been reflected in the registration system.

10.2 A review request must include the course code, dependent course, relevant grade record and supporting approval. The request should be submitted during registration or the published correction period.

10.3 Permission based only on personal assurance, informal faculty consent, work experience or self-study is not a prerequisite waiver.

11. Registration Corrections

11.1 When a prerequisite error is discovered, the department may remove the dependent course before the add deadline. After that deadline, Academic Affairs determines the academic notation and fee treatment under the applicable regulations.

11.2 A student who knowingly supplies incorrect prerequisite information may be referred for disciplinary review. Registration obtained through a system or record error does not create a right to continue in the course.

12. Interpretation

12.1 The approved programme curriculum is the primary source for course-specific prerequisite mappings. These rules control the method by which those mappings are applied.

12.2 Where a later curriculum revision or official transition order conflicts with this document, the later and more specific approved instruction prevails.